

legitimacy. All of this will provide protection and keep us from hemorrhaging cash to a crisis that never actually existed.

We don't need to be fearful of the internet, but awareness and intentionality go a long way in providing protection. When we can engage in discerning ways, there is so much benefit and community and so many resources to be found.

But What If I Don't Have the Kind of Friends I Need?

Making friends can be a daunting task. It was so easy in college and even early career life. Practically all we had to do was make a joke within the vicinity of someone our age and suddenly we're sharing chips and queso on the couch swapping insane dating stories.

As we get older, we turn more inward toward family and career, but our need for community never goes away. But because life changes, we never stop needing new friends. Relationships ebb and flow with our seasons, and they will inevitably look different in each decade of our lives. Yet again, the concept of the vital few and useful many remains a trustworthy guide in knowing what we need. We can value our "few" closest relationships and keep them with us throughout life while still benefiting from the "many" relationships that enrich our lives if only for a season.

When previous friendships have fizzled, moved away, or changed in ways that make relating difficult, it's okay to let go. When we let go of a friendship, it doesn't mean the relationship failed or that we're abandoning people, it's simply acknowledging cycles and seasons. Not every person we regularly got together with in one season needs to be the person we are currently getting together with routinely. Things change, people shift, seasons come and go, and sometimes relationships we let go of come back around! It's okay to hold these things with an open hand while also asking, "What can be woven into my life that will be helpful relationally?" Could there be groups and activities that engage you in a cherished hobby or provide mental and emotional care alongside getting you out to meet new people?